



Made to Look Real

A one-hour lesson on deepfakes and AI-made images, video and voices, for Year 8 to 11.
Students sort eight cards, learn five checks, take a case in pairs and write advice for a Year 7.

Before you start. A lesson on this can bring things up. A student may have been sent a fake image, or had one made of them, and not told anyone. Know who your safeguarding lead is, follow your school's policy if anything is mentioned, and don't ask anybody about their own experience. Slide 11 covers a fake sexual image of a student. You teach it from the slide and the answer is fixed. Law and helplines are UK ones, so check the law where you are, and give the local service if you teach outside the UK.

Print these

Page	What it is	How many
Page 2	The eight sorting cards, with three pile labels	One set per pair, cut up
Page 3	The five checks	One per table, or leave slide 8 up
Pages 4 to 6	Six case sheets, two to a page	Print the three pages three times, cut in half
Page 7	Before you share it cards, four to a page	One card each. Card stock lasts longer
Page 8	Exit slips, six to a page	One each, cut up
Pages 9 to 11	The answers, notes on slide 11, and sources	For you, not for printing

The hour, in minutes

Time	What happens	Slides
0 to 7	Read slide 2, then pairs sort the eight cards into real, made and can't tell yet.	1 to 3
7 to 11	Show what was really going on, and what the sort showed.	4
11 to 18	Teach what a deepfake is, why it is hard to tell, and the five checks.	5 to 8
18 to 22	Model the checks out loud on a voice note.	9
22 to 26	Do one together as a class, with you writing the answers up.	10
26 to 30	Teach the fake sexual image from the slide, then where to report.	11 to 12
30 to 42	Pairs fill in a case sheet.	13
42 to 46	Sheets swap and are marked against three ticks.	14
46 to 52	Every student writes a card for a Year 7.	15
52 to 57	Discussion with no right answer.	16
57 to 60	Exit slip, kept by the student and never collected.	17 to 18

Worth knowing

- In 45 minutes: give pairs eight minutes on the case sheet, drop the discussion on slide 16, and set the Year 7 card as homework. Keep slides 11 and 12.
- It covers what the 2025 RSHE guidance for England (in force from September 2026) asks secondary pupils to learn about deepfakes. Sources and dates are on page 11.





Eight things seen online

One set per pair. Cut out the cards and the three labels. Sort the cards into three piles.

1 VIDEO

A 15-second clip of a dog riding a skateboard down a hill and turning a corner perfectly. It has been shared thousands of times.

2 VOICE NOTE

A voice note from your friend Sam, who you talk to every day: “Save me a seat, I’m five minutes away.” It came from Sam’s usual account.

3 PHOTO

A photo of a snowman taller than a two-storey house, posted by a local shop with the words “Come and see it today”.

4 SCREENSHOT

A screenshot of a group chat where a classmate seems to say something unkind about another student. Nobody knows who took it.

5 VIDEO

A video of a head of year in front of the school sign, announcing a surprise day off. The blinking looks a little odd.

6 PHOTO

A photo of a girl at a music festival, waving. One of her hands looks as if it has six fingers.

7 VOICE NOTE

A voice note that sounds like a girl in your year saying something rude about a friend of hers. Somebody else sent it to you.

8 VIDEO

A video of a cyclist riding down a market street, filmed from behind by a friend, with people stepping out of the way.

Real

A person made it, and it shows what really happened.

Made

A computer made it, or changed it, so it no longer shows what happened.

Can't tell yet

There is not enough to decide. This pile is allowed to be big.





The five checks

For any video, image, voice note or screenshot you can't be sure about.

1

Who posted it first?

Find the earliest post you can. A new account with no history, or a name you do not recognise, is a warning. A friend passing it on is not the same as the person who first posted it.

2

Where else is it?

Search for it. If something big is real, several trusted places will have it. If it exists in only one chat or one account, be careful.

3

Does it want a fast reaction?

Fakes and scams push you to act before you think: send it, pay, tell everyone, click now. The pressure is a clue in itself.

4

Would they really say or do this?

Ask whether it fits what you know about this person or this place. Would they use those words, in that place, in that way?

5

Can I ask them another way?

Ask face to face, or ask an adult who would know. Do not reply in the same chat, or to the number or account it came from.

Still can't tell? Don't share it, and tell an adult if it could hurt somebody.

The exception. One kind of fake needs no checking: a sexual image of a real student. Don't open it, save it or pass it on, and tell an adult straight away.



The voice note

A voice note arrives from a parent's account. It sounds exactly like them. They say they have lost their phone, this is a friend's, and you need to send some money right now. They ask you not to tell anyone at home yet.

NAMES _____

1 What would you check?

Write the number of the check, then what you would find out.

1 Who first? · 2 Where else? · 3 Fast reaction? · 4 Would they? · 5 Ask another way

CHECK	WHAT YOU WOULD FIND OUT

2 What would you do?

3 Who would you tell?

☐ Someone at home ☐ My form tutor ☐ The safeguarding lead ☐ The person it is about ☐ The platform

MARKED BY _____

TICK WHAT THE SHEET HAS

☐ Names at least two of the five checks ☐ Gives a next step that keeps everybody safe ☐ Says who to tell

One thing I would add _____



The video of a teacher

A video is going round your year group. It shows one of your teachers in their classroom, saying something cruel about a student. Some people say it is real. Others say it can't be.

NAMES _____

1 What would you check?

Write the number of the check, then what you would find out.

1 Who first? · 2 Where else? · 3 Fast reaction? · 4 Would they? · 5 Ask another way

CHECK	WHAT YOU WOULD FIND OUT

2 What would you do?

3 Who would you tell?

☐ Someone at home ☐ My form tutor ☐ The safeguarding lead ☐ The person it is about ☐ The platform

MARKED BY _____

TICK WHAT THE SHEET HAS

☐ Names at least two of the five checks ☐ Gives a next step that keeps everybody safe ☐ Says who to tell

One thing I would add _____



The edited photo

Someone has put a Year 9 student's face onto a photo of a person falling over in a shop. It is in the year group chat, and lots of people are sharing it and laughing.

NAMES _____

1 What would you check?

Write the number of the check, then what you would find out.

1 Who first? · 2 Where else? · 3 Fast reaction? · 4 Would they? · 5 Ask another way

CHECK	WHAT YOU WOULD FIND OUT

2 What would you do?

3 Who would you tell?

☐ Someone at home ☐ My form tutor ☐ The safeguarding lead ☐ The person it is about ☐ The platform

MARKED BY _____

TICK WHAT THE SHEET HAS

☐ Names at least two of the five checks ☐ Gives a next step that keeps everybody safe ☐ Says who to tell

One thing I would add _____



The app

Someone in your form says there is an app that can make anyone look like anything. You just give it a photo of somebody. They offer to show you, using a photo of another student.

NAMES _____

1 What would you check?

Write the number of the check, then what you would find out.

1 Who first? · 2 Where else? · 3 Fast reaction? · 4 Would they? · 5 Ask another way

CHECK	WHAT YOU WOULD FIND OUT

2 What would you do?

3 Who would you tell?

☐ Someone at home ☐ My form tutor ☐ The safeguarding lead ☐ The person it is about ☐ The platform

MARKED BY _____

TICK WHAT THE SHEET HAS

☐ Names at least two of the five checks ☐ Gives a next step that keeps everybody safe ☐ Says who to tell

One thing I would add _____



The news clip

A news clip is spreading. It has a news logo, a presenter and the right music. It says your school buses will stop running tomorrow, and people are already telling their parents.

NAMES _____

1 What would you check?

Write the number of the check, then what you would find out.

1 Who first? · 2 Where else? · 3 Fast reaction? · 4 Would they? · 5 Ask another way

CHECK	WHAT YOU WOULD FIND OUT

2 What would you do?

3 Who would you tell?

☐ Someone at home ☐ My form tutor ☐ The safeguarding lead ☐ The person it is about ☐ The platform

MARKED BY _____

TICK WHAT THE SHEET HAS

☐ Names at least two of the five checks ☐ Gives a next step that keeps everybody safe ☐ Says who to tell

One thing I would add _____



The giveaway

A video of a streamer you follow says the first thousand people to click a link get free game credit. The face and the voice look right. The streamer's own page doesn't mention it.

NAMES _____

1 What would you check?

Write the number of the check, then what you would find out.

1 Who first? · 2 Where else? · 3 Fast reaction? · 4 Would they? · 5 Ask another way

CHECK	WHAT YOU WOULD FIND OUT

2 What would you do?

3 Who would you tell?

☐ Someone at home ☐ My form tutor ☐ The safeguarding lead ☐ The person it is about ☐ The platform

MARKED BY _____

TICK WHAT THE SHEET HAS

☐ Names at least two of the five checks ☐ Gives a next step that keeps everybody safe ☐ Says who to tell

One thing I would add _____



Before you share it cards

One card each. Cut along the dashed lines. Card stock lasts longer than paper.

Before you share it

FOR A YEAR 7

TWO CHECKS, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

IF I CAN'T TELL

WHO TO TELL

WRITTEN BY _____

Before you share it

FOR A YEAR 7

TWO CHECKS, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

IF I CAN'T TELL

WHO TO TELL

WRITTEN BY _____

Before you share it

FOR A YEAR 7

TWO CHECKS, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

IF I CAN'T TELL

WHO TO TELL

WRITTEN BY _____

Before you share it

FOR A YEAR 7

TWO CHECKS, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

IF I CAN'T TELL

WHO TO TELL

WRITTEN BY _____





Your exit slip

One each. Cut along the dashed lines.

Exit slip

Fold it and keep it. Nobody reads it.

One thing I will check the next time I am not sure something is real.

One adult I could tell if something like this happened to me or a friend.

Exit slip

Fold it and keep it. Nobody reads it.

One thing I will check the next time I am not sure something is real.

One adult I could tell if something like this happened to me or a friend.

Exit slip

Fold it and keep it. Nobody reads it.

One thing I will check the next time I am not sure something is real.

One adult I could tell if something like this happened to me or a friend.

Exit slip

Fold it and keep it. Nobody reads it.

One thing I will check the next time I am not sure something is real.

One adult I could tell if something like this happened to me or a friend.

Exit slip

Fold it and keep it. Nobody reads it.

One thing I will check the next time I am not sure something is real.

One adult I could tell if something like this happened to me or a friend.

Exit slip

Fold it and keep it. Nobody reads it.

One thing I will check the next time I am not sure something is real.

One adult I could tell if something like this happened to me or a friend.





The answers, for you

The starter, the model and the guided case. The six cases and slide 11 are on the next page.

THE STARTER, SLIDE 4

	WHAT IT IS	ANSWER	WHY
1	Video	Made	An AI video. It is too perfect, and nobody knows where it started.
2	Voice note	Real	It came from Sam's own account and fits what Sam does every day.
3	Photo	Made	An AI image. A snowman that tall would be news everywhere.
4	Screenshot	Can't tell	A screenshot can be edited in a minute, and you can't see where it came from.
5	Video	Made	An AI video. The odd blinking gave it away, but better fakes don't.
6	Photo	Real	A real photo. Movement blurred her hand. A strange hand does not prove a fake.
7	Voice note	Can't tell	A voice can be copied from a few seconds of audio, and you can't tell who made this one.
8	Video	Real	A friend filmed it, so there is somebody to ask.

THE MODEL, SLIDE 9

A voice note goes round the year group chat. It sounds like a teacher: "Tomorrow's trip is cancelled. Please tell everyone."

Who first?	Somebody sent it to a student. Nobody can say who posted it first.
Where else?	It is not in the school notices, and no teacher has mentioned it.
Fast reaction?	It says "tell everyone", so it wants to spread now.
Would they?	Trips are announced by email or in person, not by voice note.

Ask another way I ask the teacher in person tomorrow, or the school office.

I can't tell whether the voice is real. Four checks say don't pass it on, so I don't.

THE GUIDED CASE, SLIDE 10

A photo of the town bridge with a huge crack down the middle is spreading. It was posted by an account with no other posts, and hundreds of people are commenting "it's going to fall".

- 1 Who first? An account with no other posts. That is a warning.
- 2 Where else? No news, no council notice and no engineers. A real cracked bridge would be everywhere.
- 3 Fast reaction? Hundreds of people commenting "it's going to fall" pushes you to react.
- 4 Would they? Nobody official has said anything.
- 5 Ask another way? Ask an adult who would know, or look at the council's own notices.
- 6 What to do: don't share it, and if someone you know is worried, tell them what you checked.





The six cases, and slide 11

What a strong sheet says. Any safe next step counts, and “tell an adult” is always a good ending.

CASE	CHECKS	A STRONG SHEET SAYS
A The voice note	3, 4 and 5	Do: Don't send anything. Ask them face to face, or ask another adult at home who can reach them. Tell: Another adult at home. Your form tutor if it has frightened you.
B The video of a teacher	1, 2 and 4	Do: Don't pass it on, and don't argue about whether it is real. Report it on the platform. Tell: Your form tutor or the safeguarding lead. The teacher in it should be told through the school.
C The edited photo	1 and 4	Do: It is plainly edited, so the checks matter less than the harm. Don't share it or react to it, and report it. Tell: Your form tutor. If you know the student in it, tell them kindly and privately.
D The app	4 and 5	Do: Say no, and don't give the app a photo of anyone. Once a photo is uploaded, it is out of your control. Tell: Your form tutor, straight away, if it is used on anybody.
E The news clip	1, 2 and 3	Do: Check the school's own notices before you pass it on, and tell whoever is telling their parents. Tell: Your form tutor or the school office.
F The giveaway	1, 2 and 3	Do: Don't click. Look at the streamer's own page, and report the video as a scam. Tell: The friends who shared it. An adult, if anybody clicked or typed in details.

A strong sheet names at least two checks by number, has a next step that is not to share it, confront somebody or reply in anger, and says who to tell.

SLIDE 11, A FAKE SEXUAL IMAGE OF A STUDENT

Read the slide as it is written. There is nothing to check and nothing to decide, and the answer is the same every time: don't open it, save it or pass it on, and tell an adult.

Do not ask whether anyone has seen one, or whether it is about them. Say that a student who tells you has done nothing wrong, and that you will take it seriously.

If a student tells you, now or later, do not ask to see the image and do not ask them to delete it. In England, the DfE and UKCIS advice on sharing nudes and semi-nudes says staff should never view, copy, print, share, store or save the image, and should report to the safeguarding lead straight away.

The discussion on slide 16 is about a joke fake, like a silly photo. Slide 11 is the limit: a sexual image is never a joke.





Sources, and what will date

Every figure and legal statement in the lesson. Figures will date, and the law differs by country, so check both before you teach.
Checked 29 September 2026.

RSHE guidance	“About the prevalence of deepfakes including videos and photos, how deepfakes can be used maliciously as well as for entertainment, the harms that can be caused by deepfakes and how to identify them.” Secondary, Online safety and awareness. Department for Education, RSHE statutory guidance, July 2025, in force from September 2026.
RSHE guidance	“That keeping or forwarding indecent or sexual images of someone under 18 is a crime, even if the photo is of themselves or of someone who has consented, and even if the image was created by the child and/or using AI generated imagery.” The same section.
Ofcom	43% of people aged 16 and over, and 50% of children aged 8 to 15, had seen at least one deepfake online in the past six months. 9% of those aged 16 and over said they were confident they could identify one. Ofcom deepfakes polls, June 2024, 2,000 UK adults and 1,000 children in Great Britain.
Starling Bank	Scammers can copy a voice from “just three seconds of audio”, for example from a video posted online. Starling Bank with Mortar Research, more than 3,000 UK adults, reported September 2024. The bank also advises agreeing a safe phrase with family.
Law, England and Wales	Making, having or sharing an indecent image of a child is illegal, and this includes AI-generated images (pseudo-photographs): Protection of Children Act 1978 and Criminal Justice Act 1988 s.160. Scotland and Northern Ireland have their own equivalent laws. GOV.UK, Crime and Policing Act 2026 factsheet on child sexual abuse material.
Law, adults	Sharing an intimate image of an adult without consent is an offence, including one that has been edited or faked: Online Safety Act 2023 s.188, in force from 31 January 2024. Creating one without consent is an offence: Data (Use and Access) Act 2025 s.138, in force from 6 February 2026.
Law, tools	The Crime and Policing Act 2026 adds offences for making or supplying tools built to create these images, including a five-year maximum for a tool built to create child sexual abuse imagery. Check with your safeguarding lead what is in force where you teach.
Staff response	DfE and UKCIS, Sharing nudes and semi-nudes: how to respond to an incident, updated 11 March 2024. Staff should never view, copy, print, share, store or save the image, should not delete it or ask a young person to, and should report to the safeguarding lead immediately.
Reporting	Childline, 0800 1111, free and confidential. Report Remove, from Childline and the Internet Watch Foundation, is for under 18s in the UK to report a nude or sexual image or video of themselves. The IWF says young people use it for images that were faked or AI-manipulated (IWF news release, 10 August 2026). A fake should also go to the safeguarding lead. CEOP, the National Crime Agency, takes reports of online sexual abuse of a child.

